Woven Geography

WHAT IF A SAREE could become a map of India, its fabric tracing the contours of a landscape and its craftsmanship traversing the country. The Jamban Saree by Delhi-based Studio Medium is an exquisite expression of this imagination, where geography becomes poetry in silk.

Conceived by NID-trained designer duo Dhruv Satija and Riddhi Jain, Jamban brings together two venerable textile traditions: Bengal's intricate Jamdani weaving and Kutch's exquisite Bandhani tie-dye. Its name, like its creation, is a marriage of the two.

But this is no conventional fusion of crafts. The designers envisioned a seamless textile, liberated from the traditional demarcations of border and pallu. First woven in Bengal, shimmering zari threads meander across the silk in leher, or wave-like Jamdani patterns. The saree then journeys westward to Kutch, where master artisans painstakingly introduce Bandhani resist-dyeing along the woven contours. The resulting asymmetric patterns evoke an aerial landscape of undulating rivers, mosaic fields and shifting terrain.

Each saree demands three to four months of meticulous craftsmanship, involving ten artisans across two distant regions. Priced at ₹75,000, its luxury lies not merely in rarity but in the extraordinary dialogue between inherited skill and contemporary imagination.Exhibited as textile art at the National Museum in 2024, The Jamban Saree transcends fashion. It is a landscape to be worn, and a geography of craftsmanship to be cherished.

THE JAMBAN SAREE BY STUDIO MEDIUM

SARI DRAPING - **ANKITA ROHTAGI** • MAKEUP ARTIST - **SUJEET KUMAR**